

Chapter 52-2

Liang Shi felt relieved in her heart.

The director's face fell upon hearing this. Anyone could see that Qi Taitai wanted to have dinner with Liang Shi, but now asking him to accompany her instead—wouldn't that be slighting Qi Taitai?

This was the wife of their drama's biggest investor!

If they offended her and the funding didn't come through, how could they continue filming?

All the preliminary preparation work would probably go to waste.

The director absolutely couldn't let this happen, but he didn't dare make things difficult for Zhao Ying either. After all, everyone knew Zhao Ying's family background wasn't simple—the Zhao family alone was enough to give him trouble.

After thinking it over, the easiest person to bully here was Liang Shi.

A newcomer with no distinguished family background. From her plain clothes and the car she drove, she was clearly different from someone like Zhao Ying, a wealthy young lady who had smooth sailing all her life.

The director, shrewd as he was, quickly figured all this out and immediately continued along with Zhao Ying's words: "Then you can eat with your cousin! I'll get to know Liang Shi better—after all, we'll be filming together later."

"There's plenty of time to get acquainted later, isn't there?" Zhao Ying firmly protected Liang Shi. "We already made plans today, and my cousin has a bad temper—she'll explode if she gets stood up."

Zhao Ying's cousin—that would be a Zhao family young lady.

Naturally someone the director couldn't afford to offend either.

Zhao Ying had calculated this point precisely.

In this circle, did the Zhao family need to fear the wife of some Qida¹ company?

Even if CEO Qi himself came, he'd have to politely greet Zhao Xuning.

CEO Qi's business empire was large, but not large enough to be untouchable.

It was still far from reaching the status of Haizhou's² two prominent families.

It was at most on par with the Zhao family.

Zhao Ying still had to work in the entertainment industry and didn't want any bad reputation, so she frantically used Zhao Xuning's "tiger skin"³ as protection.

Qi Taitai glanced at Zhao Ying, her crimson lips curving upward: "You're Zhao Ying?"

Zhao Ying nodded: "Hello."

"Zhao Yulin's daughter?" Qi Taitai's voice was gentle, just like a kind elder making small talk with you.

Zhao Ying nodded again: "Zhao Yulin is my mother. Do you know each other?"

Qi Taitai smiled: "We're acquainted. We've played mahjong together."

Zhao Ying: "..."

Bringing this up made Zhao Ying unhappy. She said coldly: "My mother stopped playing mahjong ten years ago."

Qi Taitai didn't show any displeasure at her rudeness, instead continuing to smile: "Yes, that's why I said we used to play mahjong together."

Zhao Ying: "...Oh."

Everyone knew her mother had once been severely addicted to mahjong, nearly losing the family business because of it.

It was her uncle's family—Zhao Xuning's family—who had bailed them out once.

Otherwise, their family would have fallen apart because of that addiction.

As someone who had experienced all of this, Zhao Ying naturally couldn't have a good attitude toward her mother's mahjong partners.

However, Qi Taitai's target wasn't her—she was just making casual conversation.

After the small talk, she turned her gaze to Liang Shi. Those eyes rippled like water, full of charm even without speaking. But the moment Liang Shi met her gaze, she felt that cold intent.

Hidden in the depths of her eyes were many emotions Liang Shi couldn't understand.

Liang Shi shuddered but also pinched her own leg where others couldn't see, forcing herself to calm down.

She couldn't always rely on Zhao Ying's protection.

Zhao Ying had already helped her a lot.

So even though Liang Shi was afraid, she firmly met Qi Taitai's gaze, feigning composure.

Qi Taitai looked at her, paused, then said: "I heard you had a falling out with your mother?"

An attitude of an elder lecturing a junior.

Hearing this, Liang Shi's brow furrowed tightly. After a moment, she replied: "What business is it of yours?"

Everyone: "..."

Footnotes: ¹ Qida: The name of CEO Qi's company ² Haizhou: The city where the story takes place ³

Tiger skin: Chinese idiom meaning to use someone else's authority or reputation for protection